SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

18 March 2020 · Shift 3

48 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 52 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

English Language (Basic Knowledge) 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. EXPLICIT

(A) Equivocal
(B) Lucid
(C) Unintelligible
(D) Compatible

Q.2

In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. The simplest way to get proper recognition are through doing things with dedication and sincerity.

(A) with dictation and sincerity
(B) are through doing things
(C) to get proper recognition
(D) The simplest way

Q.3

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. A person who speaks always in praise of himself

(A) Nationalist
(B) Egotist
(C) Conventionalist
(D) Evangelist

Q.4

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Cut to the chase

(A) Talking about the important point and leaving out the detail
(B) Sleeping long hours and spoiling the health
(C) Cutting long pieces and spoiling the dish cooked
(D) Stopping unexpectedly and missing the chase

Q.5

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Everyone wants to be happy. I also want to be happy (1)_____ that's when I am at my best. I know that happiness comes from (2)_____ me, not from outside. The (3)_____ tools I will have to learn to use here will only work if I understand that I'm in (4)_____ of my thoughts, actions and emotions and if I'm willing to do some simple exercises on a (5)_____ basis.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 1.

(A) unless
(B) nevertheless
(C) because
(D) until

Q.6

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Everyone wants to be happy. I also want to be happy (1)_____ that's when I am at my best. I know that happiness comes from (2)_____ me, not from outside. The (3)_____ tools I will have to learn to use here will only work if I understand that I'm in (4)_____ of my thoughts, actions and emotions and if I'm willing to do some simple exercises on a (5)_____ basis.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 2.

(A) for
(B) within
(C) around
(D) on

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Everyone wants to be happy. I also want to be happy (1)_____ that's when I am at my best. I know that happiness comes from (2)_____ me, not from outside. The (3)_____ tools I will have to learn to use here will only work if I understand that I'm in (4)_____ of my thoughts, actions and emotions and if I'm willing to do some simple exercises on a (5)_____ basis.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 3.

(A) stable
(B) affective
(C) powerful
(D) effortless

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Everyone wants to be happy. I also want to be happy (1)_____ that's when I am at my best. I know that happiness comes from (2)_____ me, not from outside. The (3)_____ tools I will have to learn to use here will only work if I understand that I'm in (4)_____ of my thoughts, actions and emotions and if I'm willing to do some simple exercises on a (5)_____ basis.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 4.

(A) custody
(B) charge
(C) structure
(D) frame

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Everyone wants to be happy. I also want to be happy (1)_____ that's when I am at my best. I know that happiness comes from (2)_____ me, not from outside. The (3)_____ tools I will have to learn to use here will only work if I understand that I'm in (4)_____ of my thoughts, actions and emotions and if I'm willing to do some simple exercises on a (5)_____ basis.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 5.

(A) legal
(B) stimulant
(C) temporary
(D) regular

Q.10

Select the wrongly spelt word.

(A) Solvent
(B) Residual
(C) Envioronment
(D) Pollutant

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. "As long as" they are here, Hari won't attend the training.

(A) So long so
(B) As long that
(C) So far as
(D) No improvement

Q.13

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. PLACATE

(A) Conciliate
(B) Enrage
(C) Propitiate
(D) Appease

Q.14

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. CLOUDY

(A) Transparent
(B) Indefinite
(C) Vague
(D) Murky

Q.15

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options select the one that gives their correct order. A. Though John found none, he was not ready to give in. B. He continued the search till noon. C. John wanted to have a big well dug. D. He searched around for workers who would do the job for him without pay.

(A) DCAB
(B) CADB
(C) CDAB
(D) CDBA

Q.16

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. INSTIGATE

(A) Stagnate
(B) Kindle
(C) Instill
(D) Imbibe

Q.17

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. Sheetal might have misplaced Mohan's wallet in their rush.

(A) Mohan's wallet might have been misplaced by Sheetal in their rush.
(B) Mohan's wallet might be misplaced by Sheetal in their rush.
(C) Mohan's wallet may be misplaced by Sheetal in their rush.
(D) Mohan's wallet may have been misplaced by Sheetal in their rush.

Q.18

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Painless death given to patients to relieve suffering.

(A) Euthanasia
(B) Euphoria
(C) Euphorbia
(D) Euphemism

Q.19

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. Success is the _____ of taking risks, everybody knows.

(A) by-product
(B) burden
(C) tension
(D) pressure

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Keep a civil tongue

(A) Speak with great politeness
(B) Maintain silence when needed
(C) Argue with soft words
(D) Express dissent mildly

Q.21

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. The storekeeper asked the security, "Did you see the torch I kept here?"

(A) The storekeeper asked the security whether he saw the torch he had kept there.

(B) The storekeeper asked the security if he saw the torch he kept there.

(C) The storekeeper asked the security if had he seen the torch he kept there.

(D) The storekeeper asked the security whether he had seen the torch he had kept there.

Q.22

In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. The man with a lost eye have been accused for murder of two girls in his neighbourhood.

(A) have been accused for

(B) in his neighbourhood

(C) murder of two girls

(D) The man with a lost eye

Q.23

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. "Lot of times" she advised him for not being lazy for completing such a tough task.

(A) A lot of times

(B) No improvement

(C) Much of time

(D) A lot of time

Q.24

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. People readily accept any _____ of their leaders if supported by the media.

(A) concession

(B) compromise

(C) argument

(D) dispute

Q.25

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options select the one that gives their correct order. A. When Franco was young; he would stay at sea all night. B. Every morning, he would arrive with a big catch of fresh fish and sell it in the market. C. Franco was a fisherman who lived on the beach. D. He had been fishing for as long as he could remember.

(A) CBDA

(B) CDAB

(C) CDBA

(D) DCAB

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

In which year was the Soil Survey of India established to carry out scientific surveys of soils?

(A) 1962

(B) 1950

(C) 1947

(D) 1956

Q.2

Which part of a plant cell traps sunlight to make sugar?

(A) Chloroplast

(B) Starch grain

(C) Chromoplast

(D) Leucoplast

Q.3

In which state of India does the sunrise first appear?

(A) Arunachal Pradesh

(B) Odisha

(C) Meghalaya

(D) West Bengal

Q.4

Through a smart movement using a pawn, Himal Gusain outshone grandmaster NR Visakh. Which game are we talking about?

(A) Carrom
(B) Table Tennis
(C) Chess
(D) Shooting

Q.5

The first Education Minister of Independent India was _____.

(A) Pranab Mukherjee
(B) Indira Gandhi
(C) Abul Kalam Azad
(D) Triguna Sen

Q.6

To scale Mount Everest, mountaineers need to go to _____.

(A) Afghanistan
(B) Bhutan
(C) Nepal
(D) Myanmar

Q.7

Sankranti, the harvest festival, is celebrated in the month of Magh of the Hindu calendar and is known by different names in different parts of India. What is it called in Gujarat?

(A) Uttarayan
(B) Pana Sankranti
(C) Lohri
(D) Maghi

Q.8

Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant in Tamil Nadu is set up in collaboration with:

(A) US
(B) France
(C) Russia
(D) Australia

Q.9

Identify the correctly matched pair of the founder and the social/socio-religious organisation founded.

(A) Dayanand Saraswati – Brahmo Samaj
(B) Raja Ram Mohan Ray – Arya Samaj
(C) Rama Krishna Paramahansa – Ramakrishna Mission
(D) Swami Vivekananda – Ramakrishna Mission

Q.10

Name the filmmaker who made the Hindi film, ‘Chhapaak’, based on the story of an acid attack victim.

(A) Yash Chopra
(B) Rani Mukherji
(C) Meghna Gulzar
(D) Deepika Padukone

Q.12

When did the Prime Minister of India declare the country as 'Open Defecation Free'?

(A) 67th Republic day
(B) Mahatma Gandhi's 70th death anniversary
(C) Mahatma Gandhi's 150th birth anniversary
(D) 72nd Independence day

Q.13

Which of the following is the apex banking institution of India that regulates the monetary policy?

(A) Reserve Bank of India
(B) Axis Bank
(C) State Bank of India
(D) Bank of India

Q.14
Identify the INCORRECT statement about Public Distribution System (PDS) in India.

(A) From 1997, PDS became TPDS for targeted consumers.
(B) PDS was envisaged in 1967 as a price support programme to help consumers.
(C) Those living below poverty line get food grains at subsidised prices.
(D) PDS has been abandoned in the country since 2007.

Q.15
With which of the following sports/games is Smriti Mandhana associated?

(A) Lawn Tennis
(B) Table Tennis
(C) Cricket
(D) Hockey

Q.16
In which of the following place, are the Dilwara temples of Jainism located?

(A) Mount Abu
(B) Bhubaneswar
(C) Indore
(D) Jaipur

Q.17
Who won the ‘ICC Cricketer of the Year’, ‘ICC Test Player of the Year’ and ‘ICC ODI Player of the Year’ in 2018?

(A) Rishabh Pant
(B) Rohit Sharma
(C) Shikhar Dhawan
(D) Virat Kohli

Q.18
Who is known as the 'Father of the Nation' in India?

(A) Mahadev Govind Ranade
(B) Bhim Rao Ambedkar
(C) Swami Vivekananda
(D) Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi

Q.19
Which unit of the computer is considered as the brain of the computer?

(A) Memory unit
(B) Input unit
(C) CPU
(D) Output unit

Q.20
Which of the following options correctly defines a firewall (in the context of computing)?

(A) It is the name of a software.
(B) It is a hardware device.
(C) It is a combination of both, software and hardware devices to permit or deny network transmission based on a set of rules.
(D) It is a combination of software and hardware-based devices to permit any and every network transmission.

Q.21
What is the chemical name of the salt found abundantly in seawater?

(A) Sodium Nitrite
(B) Sodium Acetate
(C) Sodium Chloride
(D) Sodium Tartrate

Q.22
The pH of a liquid was found to be 7. Which liquid is it likely to be?

(A) Alkali
(B) Acid
(C) Water
(D) Saline

Q.23

Pablo Picasso, Claude Monet, Salvador Dali, Vincent Van Gogh were famous for their_____.

(A) artwork
(B) western music
(C) social work
(D) ballet performances

Q.24

Which of the following is the SI unit of thermodynamic temperature?

(A) Radian
(B) Celsius
(C) Kelvin
(D) Fahrenheit

Q.25

In which year did Lord Curzon order the partition of Bengal?

(A) 1905
(B) 1930
(C) 1945
(D) 1915

Answer key

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Explanations

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 · Answer (B) Lucid

'Explicit' means stated clearly and fully, leaving no doubt: 'lucid', clearly expressed. 'Equivocal' and 'unintelligible' are nearly opposite.

Q.2 · Answer (B) are through doing things

The subject, 'The simplest way', is singular, so the verb must be 'is', not 'are': 'The simplest way to get proper recognition is through doing things'.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Egotist

An egotist is a self-centred person who talks constantly about himself. An evangelist preaches a religion, and a conventionalist follows custom.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Talking about the important point and leaving out the detail

To 'cut to the chase' is to come straight to the point without wasting time on detail.

Q.5 · Answer (C) because

The clause gives the reason for wanting to be happy: 'because that's when I am at my best'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) within

Happiness comes from 'within' me, set against 'not from outside'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) powerful

'Powerful tools' are strong, effective ones that work if used well. 'Affective' means to do with feelings, and 'effortless' does not suit tools one has to learn to use.

Q.8 · Answer (B) charge

To be 'in charge of' something is to be in control of it: 'I'm in charge of my thoughts, actions and emotions'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) regular

Exercises done 'on a regular basis' are done regularly, which is how simple exercises work.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Envioronment

The correct spelling is 'environment', with no 'o' after the 'i'.

Q.11 · Answer (D) No improvement

'As long as' means while, or provided that, and fits the sentence as it stands. 'So long so' and 'As long that' are not English, and 'so far as' means to the extent that.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Enrage

To 'placate' is to calm someone's anger, so the opposite is 'enrage'. 'Conciliate', 'propitiate' and 'appease' mean the same as 'placate'.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Transparent

'Cloudy' means not clear, as a cloudy liquid is murky, so the opposite is 'transparent'. 'Indefinite', 'vague' and 'murky' are all close to 'cloudy'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) CDAB

SSC's key gives CDAB: C states John's aim, D his search for workers who would dig without pay, and A, whose 'none' points back to those workers, says he found none but would not give up, which leads to B, 'He continued the search till noon.' CDBA, putting the long search before the failure, also reads smoothly, but it separates 'none' from 'workers'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Kindle

To 'instigate' is to set something going or stir it up, as one may 'kindle' anger or a quarrel. 'Stagnate' is nearly opposite, and to 'instill' or 'imbibe' an idea is to put it in or take it in gradually.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Mohan’s wallet might have been misplaced by Sheetal in their rush.
The modal perfect 'might have misplaced' becomes 'might have been misplaced' in the passive: 'Mohan's wallet might have been misplaced by Sheetal in their rush.'

Q.18 · Answer (A) Euthanasia
Euthanasia is the painless killing of a patient suffering from an incurable, painful illness. Euphoria is intense happiness, a euphemism a mild word used in place of a harsh one, and Euphorbia a genus of plants.

Q.19 · Answer (A) by-product
A 'by-product' is something that comes about as a result of something else: success follows from taking risks.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Speak with great politeness
To 'keep a civil tongue (in one's head)' is to speak politely and not rudely.

Q.21 · Answer (D) The storekeeper asked the security whether he had seen the torch he had kept there.
A yes/no question is reported with 'whether' or 'if' in statement order; after the past reporting verb 'asked', 'did you see' and 'I kept' move back to 'he had seen' and 'he had kept', and 'here' becomes 'there'.

Q.22 · Answer (A) have been accused for
The subject 'The man' is singular, so it takes 'has', and 'accused' takes 'of': 'has been accused of murder'.

Q.23 · Answer (A) A lot of times
'Lot' needs the article: 'a lot of times' means many times, often. 'A lot of time' would mean a long time, and 'much of time' is not idiomatic.

Q.24 · Answer (C) argument
An 'argument' here is a reason or case put forward: people readily accept what their leaders argue when the media backs it. A 'concession', 'compromise' or 'dispute' does not suit being accepted on the media's support.

Q.25 · Answer (B) CDAB
C introduces Franco the fisherman, D says he had fished for as long as he could remember, A goes back to his youth, when he stayed at sea all night, and B tells what he did each morning after: CDAB.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) 1956
The Soil Survey of India was set up in 1956, as the All India Soil Survey Organisation; it grew into the National Bureau of Soil Survey and Land Use Planning, an independent ICAR institute from 1976.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Chloroplast
Chloroplasts hold chlorophyll, which absorbs sunlight for photosynthesis. Chromoplasts carry other pigments that colour fruits and flowers, and leucoplasts are colourless plastids that store starch, oils or proteins.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Arunachal Pradesh
Arunachal Pradesh, the easternmost state, sees the sunrise first; Dong village in its Anjaw district is known for India's first sunrise.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Chess
The pawn is a chess piece and grandmaster a chess title, and Himal Gusain and N R Visakh are Indian chess players.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Abul Kalam Azad
Maulana Abul Kalam Azad was independent India's first Education Minister, from 1947 to 1958; his birthday, 11 November, is observed as National Education Day.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Nepal
Mount Everest stands on the border between Nepal and the Tibet region of China, and climbers approach it from one or the other. Nepal is the only such country among the options.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Uttarayan
In Gujarat Makar Sankranti is called Uttarayan and is known for kite flying. Lohri is Punjab's festival on its eve, Maghi is the Punjabi name for the day itself, and Pana Sankranti is Odisha's new year in April.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Russia
Kudankulam's reactors are Russian-designed VVER-1000 units, built with Russia under an agreement India first signed with the Soviet Union in 1988.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Swami Vivekananda – Ramakrishna Mission
Swami Vivekananda founded the Ramakrishna Mission in 1897, naming it after his guru. Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded the Brahmo Samaj and Dayanand Saraswati the Arya Samaj.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Meghna Gulzar
Meghna Gulzar directed 'Chhapaak' (2020), based on the life of the acid attack survivor Laxmi Agarwal; Deepika Padukone played the lead and co-produced it.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Mahatma Gandhi's 150th birth anniversary
On 2 October 2019, Mahatma Gandhi's 150th birth anniversary and the target date of the Swachh Bharat Mission, Prime Minister Narendra Modi declared rural India open defecation free at an event in Ahmedabad.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Reserve Bank of India
The Reserve Bank of India, set up in 1935, is the country's central bank and frames and carries out its monetary policy. The other three are commercial banks.

Q.14 · Answer (D) PDS has been abandoned in the country since 2007.
The PDS was never abandoned: in June 1997 it became the Targeted PDS, and when the exam was held (March 2020) it was running under the National Food Security Act, 2013. Histories of the PDS describe it as a price support for consumers during the food shortages of the 1960s.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Cricket
Smriti Mandhana is a cricketer; when the exam was held (March 2020) she was an opening batter for the India women's team.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Mount Abu
The Dilwara temples, Jain temples in white marble, the earliest built in 1031, stand at Mount Abu in Rajasthan.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Virat Kohli
In the ICC awards for 2018, announced in January 2019, Virat Kohli won all three: Cricketer of the Year (the Sir Garfield Sobers Trophy), Test Player of the Year and ODI Player of the Year, the first player to do so.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi
Mahatma Gandhi is called the Father of the Nation; Subhas Chandra Bose addressed him as the 'Father of our Nation' in a radio broadcast in 1944.

Q.19 · Answer (C) CPU
The central processing unit carries out program instructions and controls the other units, so it is called the brain of the computer.

Q.20 · Answer (C) It is a combination of both, software and hardware devices to permit or deny network transmission based on a set of rules.
A firewall watches network traffic and allows or blocks it according to a set of security rules; it may be software, hardware or both. A firewall that let every transmission through would do nothing.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Sodium Chloride
Common salt, sodium chloride, makes up most of the salt dissolved in seawater.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Water

SSC's key gives water: pure water is neutral, with a pH of 7, while acids are below 7 and alkalis above. A solution of common salt is also neutral in theory, which makes 'saline' arguable, but water is the standard example of a neutral liquid.

Q.23 · Answer (A) artwork

All four were painters: Picasso and Dalí were Spanish, Monet French and Van Gogh Dutch.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Kelvin

The kelvin is the SI base unit of thermodynamic temperature; the degree Celsius is derived from it, and the radian is the unit of plane angle.

Q.25 · Answer (A) 1905

Lord Curzon announced the partition of Bengal in 1905; it took effect on 16 October 1905 and was annulled in 1911.

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